

COURSE MATERIAL

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SEMESTER	I
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1. COURSE OBJECTIVES

The objectives of this course are to

1. Facilitate effective listening skills for better comprehension of academic lectures and English spoken by native speakers.
2. Focus on appropriate reading strategies for comprehension of various academic texts and authentic materials.
3. Help improve speaking skills through participation in activities such as role plays, Discussions and structured talks/oral presentations.
4. Impart effective strategies for good writing and demonstrate the same in summarizing, writing well organized essays, record and report useful information.
5. Provide knowledge of grammatical structures and vocabulary and encourage their appropriate use in speech and writing.

2. PREREQUISITES

Students should have knowledge on

1. Enhancing communication skills.
2. Learning LSRW Skills and vocabulary.

3. SYLLABUS

Lesson: INSPIRATION: The Toys of Peace

Listening: Making predictions while listening to conversations/transactional dialogues without video; listening with video.

Speaking: Role plays for practice of conversational English in academic contexts (formal and informal)-asking for and giving information/directions.

Reading: Studying the use of graphic elements in texts to convey information, reveal trends/patterns/relationships, communicate processes or display complicated data.

Writing: Letter Writing: Official Letters, resumes

Grammar: Reporting verbs, Direct and indirect speech, Active & Passive Voice

Vocabulary: Words often confused, Jargons

1. Learning Outcomes

At the end of the module, the learners will be able to

- Infer and predict about content of spoken discourse
- Understand verbal and non-verbal features of communication and hold formal/informal conversations
- Interpret graphic elements used in academic texts
- Produce a coherent paragraph interpreting a figure/graph/chart/table
- Use language appropriate for description and interpretation of graphic elements

4. Co-PO/PSOMapping

The Toys of Peace	PO1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO6	PO7	PO8	PO9	PO10	PO11	PO12	PSO1	PSO2
CO1									2	2				
CO2									2	2				
CO3									2	2				
CO4									3	3				
CO5									3	3				

5. LESSON PLAN

LECTURE	WEEK	TOPICS TO BE COVERED	REFERENCES
1	1	Introduction	T1
2		Summary of The Essay - The Toys of Peace	T1, R1
3		Inferential Listening	T1, R1
4		Conversations in Formal and Informal Contexts	T1
5	2	Asking for and giving directions	T1
6		Asking for and giving Information	T1
7		Data interpretation	T1, R1
8		Official letters	T1, R1
9		Resume Writing	T1
10	3	Direct and Indirect Speech	T1, R1
11		Academic Reporting Verbs	R1
12		Active and Passive Voice	T1, R1
13		Words Often Confused	R1
14		Jargons	R1

6. ACTIVITY BASED LEARNING

- Enhancing speaking skills through individual activity.
- To improve public speaking ability through group activities.

7. LECTURE NOTES

Introduction of author:

Hector Hugh Munro (1870–1916), better known by the pen name Saki and also frequently as H.H. Munro, was a British writer whose stories are witty, mischievous, and sometimes macabre. They satirize Edwardian society and culture. He is considered by English teachers and scholars as a master of the short story, and often compared to O. Henry and Dorothy Parker. Influenced by Oscar Wilde, Lewis Carroll and Rudyard Kipling.

Introduction of lesson:

"The Toys of Peace" is a humorous short story by the British author Hector Hugh Munro who wrote under the pseudonym of Saki. The story was first collected in the 1919 anthology of the same title.

Set in 1914, the story satirizes the campaign by the National Peace Council, a coordinating committee of anti-war organizations, against violent toys.

The plot is set in motion when Eleanor asks her brother to buy "peace toys" instead of soldiers for her young sons. Presented with lead figures of notable civilians and other non-violent toys, the boys are at first unsure what to do. Children being resourceful, however, they soon find a way to combine the new toys with their history homework for entertainment.

Summary of the Lesson:

Eleanor Bope shows her brother Harvey a newspaper cutting about the National Peace Council. The Council will be exhibiting "peace toys" at the Children's Welfare Exhibition as an alternative to toys that promote violence. To steer boys away from their primitive instincts—since they "naturally love fighting and all the panoply of war"—the Council recommends giving them toys of civilian figures with industrial tools instead of soldiers with guns. Eleanor asks Harvey to buy her sons Eric and Bertie, aged ten and nine, some peace toys for Easter.

On Easter Saturday, Eric and Bertie watch in eager anticipation as their uncle unpacks a large box. The first item is a featureless square building. Bertie thinks it is a fort while Eric believes it is a fortified Albanian palace. Harvey tells them it is a municipal dustbin for garbage collection. He then takes out a lead figure of John Stuart Mill, the political economist. Other buildings and civilian figures follow, including a model of the Young Women's Christian Association Manchester branch building and a figure of the Sunday school founder Robert Raikes. There are also various tools and equipment such as a wheelbarrow, a sewer ventilator, and a ballot box.

Eric asks how they are supposed to play with the civilian figures. Harvey suggests staging a contest for a seat in Parliament. The boys are excited to imagine bloody drunken fights, and Harvey quickly explains the election process. The boys lose interest and decide to work on their history homework instead. They are studying Louis XIV of

France, and Eric already knows all the major battles fought during his reign. Harvey wonders whether history can be taught in elementary schools without mentioning battles, murderous intrigues, and other forms of violence.

Harvey returns later to check on the boys and finds them playing. Using the new toys, they have improvised a French invasion of Manchester. Robert Raikes is now Louis XIV, and other civilian figures are being used to represent the soldiers and the casualties. The municipal dustbin has been converted into a fort. The soldiers attack the Young Women's Christian Association and abduct the girls. J.S. Mill, in the part of Marshal Saxe, is stabbed by one of the girls. Bertie splashes red ink to illustrate the bloody death. He then proceeds to pour red ink all over the YWCA building as the soldiers massacre a hundred girls in revenge. Harvey goes to his sister and declares the experiment a failure.

Listening:

Making predictions while listening to conversations or transactional dialogues without video; listening with video.

Types of Listening Texts

One way of classifying texts that we hear is to consider two basic categories:

- Monologues: where one person does all or most of the talking
- Dialogues: where two or more people are talking together
- Scheme

These monologues or dialogues might be planned or unplanned. For example, when a student gives an oral presentation at the university, this is an example of a planned monologue.

If someone meets an old school friend in the park by accident, then their conversation is an example of an unplanned dialogue.

- View

Another basic distinction to consider is whether we can see the person who is listening to us or not. For example, a conversation with someone on the telephone is either planned or unplanned dialogue with someone unseen.

Deprived of any clues from body language, we need to listen carefully to intonation and word choice to be able to judge the other person's emotions.

- Interactivity

Another subcategory is interactional and transactional listening. Interactional is the kind of social communication that we frequently carry out when we talk to our friends.

Transactional refers to trying to obtain or exchange information. So if you listen to someone giving instructions about how to use a new computer program, this is a mainly transactional listening.

- Familiarity

Sometimes, we listen to familiar topics. In this case, we don't have to listen so carefully to every word. If we are listening to someone talking about an unfamiliar topic then we will have to pay much more attention.

Conclusion

It is important to be able to distinguish between these different types of listening because students may face different kinds of difficulties with different sorts of listening texts.

When we have a clear understanding of the difficulties that students face, we are able to choose a suitable range of techniques to help them.

Speaking

Formal and Informal conversation

Technically, formal communication refers to the flow of official information through proper, predefined channels and routes. Informal communication is generally associated with interpersonal or casual communication.

Formal versus Informal conversations with examples

As an online English teacher, my first recommendation is to observe conversation tones and then apply them. There are no shortcuts but regular, consistent practice will get you there. The second being active efforts to improve your English vocabulary. Most of us use fillers or ghost words, they adversely affect our conversation tones.

Let's see a few examples that you can start using in your daily conversations with friends or at work.

Informal sentences VS Formal sentences.

Informal	Formal
I drop and PICKUP my KIDS from school almost every day	I drop and COLLECT my CHILDREN from school almost every day.
I have FIXED UP an appointment for 7.30 pm	I have ARRANGED an appointment for 7.30 Pm
I don't go to parties BUT I went to one yesterday	I don't go to parties HOWEVER I went to One
I LIKE/ENJOY watching TV on Weekends	I PREFER watching TV on weekends
It is RIGHT to tell your teacher about your issues in writing.	It is CORRECT to tell your teacher about your issues in writing.

Informal questions VS Formal questions.

1. CAN you help me in making the flowchart of the process?
2. WILL you come with us for buying gifts for the function?

3. DOyouwantsometeaorcoffee?
4. CANyoutellmewheretheyouLIVEinyourcountry?
5. AREyoucoming?
6. COULDyouhelpmeinmakingtheflowchartoftheprocess?
7. WOULDyoucomewithusforbuyinggiftsforthefunction?
8. WOULDYOULIKETOhavesometeaorcoffee?
9. WOULDYOU MINDTELLINGMEwhereyouRESIDEinyourcountry?
10. WOULDITBEPOSSIBLEforyoutocome?

CasualVS formal(polite)questions

11. Whatplaceisit?
12. Couldyoutellmewhatplaceitis?
13. Whatishername?
14. Couldyoutellmewhathernameis?
15. WhereistheCentralbanknearapark?
16. CouldyoutellmewheretheCentralbanknearaparkis?
17. Areyouanatheist?
18. Wouldyoumindtellingmeifyouareanatheist?
19. IssheAmerican?
20. CanyoutellmeifsheisAmerican?
21. Istheofficelosingnow?
22. Couldyoutellmeiftheofficeisclosingnow?
23. Washecomingtothemeetingtoday?
24. Doyouhaveanyideaifhewascomingtothemeetingtoday?
25. Wereyoulisteningtomusiclastnight?
26. Doyoumindtellingmeifyouwerelisteningtomusiclastnight?
27. Hashebeenperformingthejobwithagrouporalone?
28. Doyouhaveanyideaifhehasbeenperformingthejobwitha
29. DoesDannycomehereregularly?
30. CanyoutellmeifDannycomeshereregularly?
31. WhereshouldIsit?
32. COULDyoukindlyinformmewhereIshouldsit?
33. Whereisthetoilet?
34. CouldyoupleasetellmewheretheLois?

grouporalone?

Lastbutcertainlynotleast,useconnectorstomaketheformalsentences insteadofonewordorone-lineranswers.Forexample-since,while,before, after,unless,whereas,once,that,wherever,whenever,although.

Let'sseefewexamplestolearnhowwecanapplythem inorconversations.

CASE1-Whatisyourfavoritecolor?

Wrong – Blue.

Wrong–MyfavoritecolorisBlue.

Correct–Well,theicolorIpreferisBlueASlalwaysendupbuyingdresses inblueMOREOVERitgivesmeafeel-goodfactorSINCEitisacolorof calmness and peace.

CASE 2- What is your profession?

Wrong – Teacher.

Wrong–Iamworkingasateacher.

Correct-SINCEIwasalwaysinterestedinteaching,presentlyIamaTeacher,
INADDITION,IwouldliketomentionthatIamquitesatisfiedwithmycareerat
themomentandCERTAINLYlookingforabrightfutureahead.

CASE3-Wheredoyoulive? Wrong

– C block.

Wrong–IliveatCblockinCentrality.

Correct–IliveinCblockwhichisoneofthebestcitiesorwhichisalsomy
hometown.FURTHER,IhavebeenlivinghereSINCEmychildhood,ultimately
thisplacehasaspecialcornerinmyheart.MOREOVER,Iwasbornand
boughthereEVENTUALLYIhavemanygoodfriends.

CASE4-Tellmeaboutyoureducation? Wrong –

I am a graduate.

Wrong–IhavecompletedmyB.A.

Correct–

Answer1-SINCEmyareaofinterestwasartsSOIcompletedmygraduation in B.A.
FURTHER,IWOULD LIKETO HIGHLIGHT that my college life shaped my
communication and interaction with people.

Answer 2- SINCE Iwas good in calculation, Iopted for Commerce. IN
ADDITION,IWOULDLIKETOSHAREthatIhadagreattimewithmycollege
friendsMOREOVERourprofessorswereverysupportive.

Asking forandgiving information:

ThesimplestwaytoaskforaninformationistouseWhy...?

WhydoIhavetofillinthisform?

WhydoIhavetowait?

Why do you refuse to admit us?

Why did they back out of the
deal?

Whydidyourejectmyapplication?

Whycan'tyoubehave?

Why do I have to obey your orders?

Why do I have to work on Saturdays?

Why can't I park here?

Why can't I borrow books from the library?

Questions beginning with 'Could you explain...?' can also be used to ask people to explain something.

Could you explain why litmus paper changes color?

Could you explain why trees shed their leaves in autumn?

Could you explain why iron rusts?

Could you explain how mutation occurs?

Could you explain how to do this calculation?

To ask for a reason, use 'What is the reason...?'

What is the reason for her unhappiness?

What is the reason for his failure?

What is the reason for the sudden change in temperature?

What is the reason for his absence?

To give an explanation: use 'Because'.

'Why are you crying?'

'Because dad scolded me.' 'Why are you late?'

'Because I missed my train.' 'Why do you want to quit?'

'Because I'm bored.' 'Why were you absent yesterday?'

'Because I was ill.'

'Why didn't she attend the meeting?'

'Because she was in Paris at that time.'

ASKING FOR AND GIVING DIRECTIONS

Under this topic title, we will learn how to ask for directions and how to give directions to someone who asked us.

Before Asking For Directions:

Starting to conversation kindly is very good way. So, when we start talking, we can use the following forms

Examples:

- Excuse me/Excuse me sir or madam.
- I am new here.
- I'm lost.
- I am sorry to interrupt you, but...
- Excuse me, could you help me, please?
- I am sorry.
- Sorry, I am not from around here.
- Excuse me madam, I seemed to be lost.
- Hello/Hello sir or madam

Asking directions:

Sometimes we or someone need to find a place. And we need to ask someone else for help. When we're asking for directions to someone, we use some phrases. These are given below;

Examples:

- ☐ Can you give me directions to the nearest hospital?
- ☐ Are we on the right road for London?
- ☐ How do you get to the bus stop?
- ☐ Where is the carnival?
- ☐ Where can I find the nearest car park?
- ☐ How do I get to library?
- ☐ Is there a pet shop near here?
- ☐ Where is the nearest post office?
- ☐ Do you know where the shopping center is?
- ☐ Is there a sport shop around here?
- ☐ Can you tell me how to get to train station from here? How can I get to the pub?
- ☐ What's the best way to get to the amusement park from here?
- ☐ What's the quickest way to get to the airport from here?
- ☐ What's the easiest way to get to the nearest drug store from here?
- ☐ Could you tell me where the nearest grocery store is?
- ☐ Where are you exactly?
- ☐ How do you get to the supermarket from here?
- ☐ I am looking for this address, am I in the right place/how can I get there?
- ☐ Can you tell me the way to the Nature Hotel?
- ☐ Is this the right way for the campground? Do you have a map?
- ☐ I am trying to find an exchange office. Could you tell me how to get there?
- ☐ I am trying to get to the police station; can you show me on the map?
- ☐ Could you help me, please? I'm looking for the bank.
- ☐ Does this bus go to the center? Do you know the cafe?

Answering the question:

1. If we don't know the answer, we can say;
 - ☐ I am sorry.
 - ☐ I don't know.
 - ☐ I am a stranger here myself.
2. If we or someone knows the question, give the directions;
 - *Commonly used verbs for giving directions are colored below.
 - A. Giving Directions to Say 'Go Straight';
 - Go straight.
 - Go along the road.
 - Go down there.
 - Go down or walk down the street.

- Gouporwalkupthestreet.
- Go straightalongthisroad.
- Gopastthebusstop.
- Gotowardthechurch.
- Goahead.
- Gostraightatthelights/attheroundabout/atthejunction.
- Continuestraightaheadforaboutamile.
- Continuepastthepetrolstation.(passthestationandcontinue)
- Continuestraightonpasttwotrafficlights.
- Continuestraightaheadforabouttwokilometers.
- Keepgoingforanotherstation.
- KeepgoingdownthisStreet.
- Keepgoingforanothershopundredmeters.
- Keepgoingstraightaheadyouwillseeitontheright.
- Keeponthestraightroad.
- Keepwalkingahead.
- Takethisroad.
- Walktothecorner.
- Followthisstreetfor300meters.
- Followtheroaduntilyougettothebank.

B. Giving Direction to Say 'Turn';

- Turnright.
- Turnleft.
- Turnleftpastthebank.(passthebankandthenturnleft)
- Turnback.(goback)
- Turnleftafterthebridge.
- Turnrightatthesecondturning(turnleftwhenyoureachthe turning)
- Turnrightfromthefirstalley.
- TurnleftontoDanielStreet.
- Turnleftattheendofthecorridor.
- Turnright/leftatthetrafficlights/roundabout&etc.
- Turnrightonafteryoupassthemarketontherightalso.
- Turnleftafteryoupassthebakery.
- Turnleftpastthephoneshop.
- Whenyouseeaschoolonyourrighthandside,turnleftin to European Street.
- Turnleftafteryoupassthebakery.
- Goright/leftattheendoftheroad.
- Takethefirstright".
- Takethefirst/second/thirdstreetontheleft/right.
- TakethefirstleftwhenyouenterStevenRoad.
- Youneedtotakealeft/arightatthenexttrafficlights.
- Takearight/leftatthejunction.
- TakethesecondexitattheT-junctionandthenturnrightatthe trafficrights.

- If you take the road on the left, you'll come to the post office.
- Take a left when you come to the main street.
- Round the corner from the post office.

c. Giving Directions to Say 'Cross';

- Cross the pub.
- Pass the school.
- You will cross some traffic lights.
- Cross the taxi rank and you are there.
- Go over the bridge.

D. Giving locations:

* Commonly used prepositions for giving locations are colored below.

It is...

- on the left.
- on left.
- on the right.
- on right side.
- on the straight ahead.
- on left after the gas station.
- straight ahead on the right.
- straight ahead of you.
- straight ahead on the left next to the bookshop.
- opposite.
- opposite the bank.
- on opposite side of the Street.
- across the road.
- near my office.
- next to Mall.
- behind the hospital.
- in front of the bus station.
- between our office and the supermarket.
- on the right in between the pet shop and the grocery store.
- at the end of Paris Street.
- on/at the corner of Daniel Road.
- over there, near the police station.
- just right/left around the corner.
- (just) around the corner.
- just around the corner on the left/right side.
- left around the corner next to the market.
- left around the corner from the subway.
- further down the road on the left.
- the biggest/smallest building on the left.
- in the center of the town.
- the first turning on the right after the bank.

Other useful phrases for giving direction:

- It is this way/that way.
- You are going to wrong way.
- You are going in the wrong direction.

- You will pass a bakery on your left.
- It will be on your left or right.
- This straight road will lead you to the hospital.
- You will see the entrance on the left.
- You will pass a taxi rank on your left.
- Follow the sign for the town center.
- You will see the car park in front of you.
- You can't miss it.
- Come off the motorway/highway at the junction.
- The signpost said "London 18 miles" or "America".
- Follow the sign to..
- You will come to a bus station.
- You will see the Black Lake.

Landmarks:

When giving directions we will often use landmarks help the other person understand where to find it.

These are listed below; traffic lights, crossroads, junction, level crossing, signpost, T-junction, dead end, underpass, roundabout, flyover, motorway, bridge, railway bridge, railway line, dual carriageway, pedestrian crossing, zebra crossing, stop sign, hospital, police station, shopping center, garage, petrol station, Airport, bus stop, station, Bookshop, Building and etc....

Asking for repetition:

- Sorry, I didn't catch that.
- Could you say that again please?
- Could you repeat it again please?
- What did you say the street's name was?
- Could you speak up please?
- Could you speak a little louder?
- Could you show me please?

Finishing Conversation:

- Thanks for help. Bye.
- Thank you for help. Goodbye.
- Thank you for spending your time with me. Have a nice day!

1.6 Reading

What is Data Interpretation?

Data interpretation is the process of reviewing data through some predefined processes which will help assign some meaning to the data and arrive at a relevant conclusion. It involves taking the result of data analysis, making inferences on the relations studied, and using them to conclude.

Therefore, before one can talk about interpreting data, they need to be analyzed first. What then, is data analysis?

Data analysis is the process of ordering, categorizing, manipulating, and summarizing data to obtain answers to research questions. It is usually the first step taken towards data interpretation.

It is evident that the interpretation of data is very important, and as such needs to be done properly. Therefore, researchers have identified some data interpretation methods to aid this process.

What are Data Interpretation Methods?

Data interpretation methods are how analysts help people make sense of numerical data that has been collected, analyzed and presented. Data, when collected in raw form, may be difficult for the layman to understand, which is why analysts need to break down the information gathered so that others can make sense of it.

For example, when founders are pitching to potential investors, they must interpret data (e.g. market size, growth rate, etc.) for better understanding. There are 2 main methods in which this can be done, namely; quantitative methods and qualitative methods.

Qualitative Data Interpretation Method

The qualitative data interpretation method is used to analyze qualitative data, which is also known as categorical data. This method uses texts, rather than numbers or patterns to describe data.

Qualitative data is usually gathered using a wide variety of person-to-person techniques, which may be difficult to analyze compared to the quantitative research method.

Unlike the quantitative data which can be analyzed directly after it has been collected and sorted, qualitative data needs to first be coded into numbers before it can be analyzed. This is because texts are usually cumbersome, and will take more time, and result in a lot of errors if analyzed in their original state. Coding done by the analyst should also be documented so that it can be reused by others and also analyzed.

There are 2 main types of qualitative data, namely; nominal and ordinal data. These 2 data types are both interpreted using the same method, but ordinal data interpretation is quite easier than that of nominal data.

In most cases, ordinal data is usually labeled with numbers during the process of data collection, and coding may not be required. This is different from nominal data that still needs to be coded for proper interpretation.

Quantitative Data Interpretation Method

The quantitative data interpretation method is used to analyze quantitative data, which is also known as numerical data. This data type contains numbers and is therefore analyzed with the use of numbers and not texts.

Quantitative data are of 2 main types, namely; discrete and continuous data. Continuous data is further divided into interval data and ratio data, with all the data types being numeric.

Due to its natural existence as a number, analysts do not need to employ the coding technique on quantitative data before it is analyzed. The process of analyzing quantitative data involves statistical modelling techniques such as standard deviation, mean and median.

Some of the statistical methods used in analyzing quantitative data are highlighted below:

- Mean

The mean is a numerical average for a set of data and is calculated by dividing the sum of the values by the number of values in a dataset. It is used to get an estimate of a large population from the dataset obtained from a sample of the population.

For example, online job boards in the US use the data collected from a group of registered users to estimate the salary paid to people of a particular profession. The estimate is usually made using the average salary submitted on their platform for each profession.

- Standard deviation

This technique is used to measure how well the responses align with or deviates from the mean. It describes the degree of consistency within the responses; together with the mean, it provides insight into datasets.

In the job board example highlighted above, if the average salary of writers in the US is \$20,000 per annum, and the standard deviation is 5.0, we can easily deduce that the salaries for the professionals are far away from each other. This will birth other questions like why the salaries deviate from each other that much.

With this question, we may conclude that the sample contains people with few years of experience, which translates to a lower salary, and people with many years of experience, translating to a higher salary. However, it does not contain people with mid-level experience.

- Frequency distribution

This technique is used to assess the demography of the respondents or the number of times a particular response appears in research. It is extremely keen on determining the degree of intersection between data points.

Some other interpretation processes of quantitative data include:

- Regression analysis
- Cohort analysis
- Predictive and prescriptive analysis

Tips for Collecting Accurate Data for Interpretation

- Identify the Required Data Type

Researchers need to identify the type of data required for particular research. Is it nominal, ordinal, interval, or ratio data?

The key to collecting the required data to conduct research is to properly understand the research question. If the researcher can understand the research question, then he can identify the kind of data that is required to carry out the research.

For example, when collecting customer feedback, the best data type to use is the ordinal data type. Ordinal data can be used to access a customer's feelings about a brand and is also easy to interpret.

- Avoid Biases

There are different kinds of biases a researcher might encounter when collecting data for analysis. Although biases sometimes come from the researcher, most of the biases encountered during the data collection process is caused by the respondent.

There are 2 main biases; that can be caused by the respondent, namely; response bias and non-response bias. Researchers may not be able to eliminate these biases, but there are ways in which they can be avoided and reduced to a minimum.

Response biases are biases that are caused by respondents intentionally giving wrong answers to responses, while non-response bias occurs when the respondents don't give answers to questions at all. Biases are capable of affecting the process of data interpretation.

- Use Close Ended Surveys

Although open-ended surveys are capable of giving detailed information about the questions and allowing respondents to fully express themselves,

It is not the best kind of survey for data interpretation. It requires a lot of coding before the data can be analyzed.

Close-ended surveys, on the other hand, restrict the respondents' answers to some predefined options, while simultaneously eliminating irrelevant data. This way, researchers can easily analyze and interpret data.

However, close-ended surveys may not be applicable in some cases, like when collecting respondents' personal information like name, credit card details, phone number, etc.

Visualization Techniques in Data Analysis

One of the best practices of data interpretation is the visualization of the dataset. Visualization makes it easy for a layman to understand the data, and also encourages people to view the data, as it provides a visually appealing summary of the data.

There are different techniques of data visualization, some of which are highlighted below.

Bar Graphs

Bar graphs are graphs that interpret the relationship between 2 or more variables using rectangular bars. These rectangular bars can be drawn either vertically or horizontally, but they are mostly drawn vertically.

The graph contains the horizontal axis (x) and the vertical axis (y), with the former representing the independent variable while the latter is the dependent variable. Bar graphs can be grouped into different types, depending on how the rectangular bars are placed on the graph.

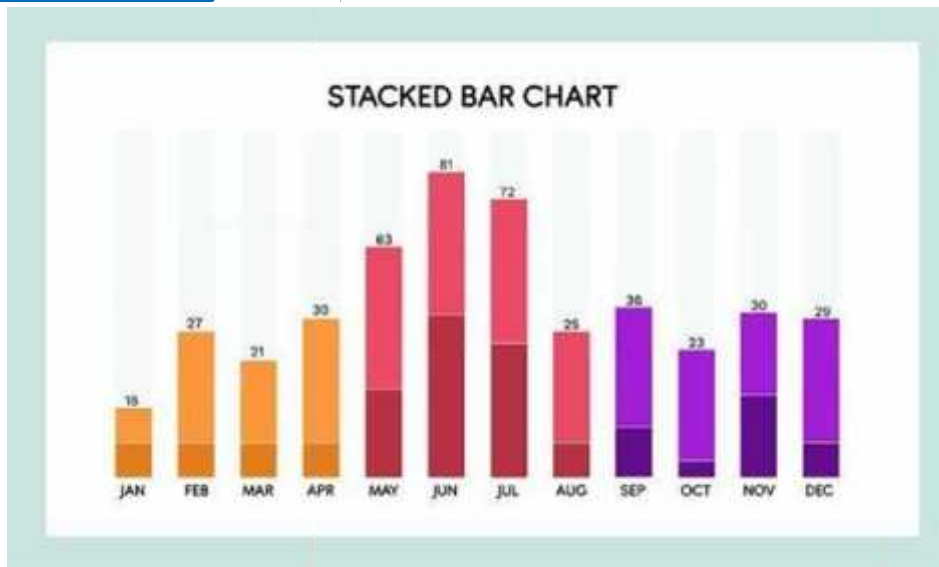
Some types of bar graphs are highlighted below:

- **Grouped Bar Graph**

The grouped bar graph is used to show more information about variables that are subgroups of the same group with each subgroup bar placed side-by-side like in a histogram.

- **Stacked Bar Graph**

A stacked bar graph is a grouped bar graph with its rectangular bars stacked on top of each other rather than placed side by side.



- **SegmentedBarGraph**

Segmented bar graphs are stacked bar graphs where each rectangular bar shows 100% of the dependent variable. It is mostly used when there is an intersection between the variable categories.

Advantages of a Bar Graph

- It helps to summarize a large data
- Estimation of key values can be made at a glance
- Can be easily understood

Disadvantages of a Bar Graph

- It may require additional explanation.
- It can be easily manipulated.
- It doesn't properly describe the dataset.

Pie Chart

A pie chart is a circular graph used to represent the percentage of occurrence of variable using sectors. The size of each sector is dependent on the frequency or percentage of the corresponding variables.

There are different variants of the pie charts, but for the sake of this article, we will be restricting ourselves to only 3. For better illustration of these types, let us consider the following examples.

Pie Chart Example: There are a total of 50 students in a class, and out of them, 10 students like Football, 25 students like snooker, and 15 students like Badminton.

- SimplePieChart

The simple pie chart is the most basic type of pie chart, which is used to depict the general representation of a bar chart.



- DoughnutPieChart

Doughnut pie is a variant of the pie chart, with a blank center allowing for additional information about the data as a whole to be included.



- 3DPieChart

3D pie chart is used to give the chart a 3D look and is often used for aesthetic purposes. It is usually difficult to reach because of the distortion of perspective due to the third dimension.

Advantages of a Pie Chart

- It is visually appealing.
- Best for comparing small data samples.

Disadvantages of a Pie Chart

- It can only compare small sample sizes.
- Unhelpful with observing trends over time.

Tables

Tables are used to represent statistical data by placing them in rows and columns. They are one of the most common statistical visualization techniques and are of 2 main types, namely; simple and complex tables.

- Simple Tables

Simple tables summarize information on a single characteristic and may also be called a univariate table. An example of a simple table showing the number of employed people in a community concerning their age group.

- Complex Tables

As its name suggests, complex tables summarize complex information and present them in two or more intersecting categories. A complex table example is a table showing the number of employed people in a population concerning their age group and sex as shown in the table below.

Advantages of Tables

- Can contain large datasets
- Helpful in comparing 2 or more similar things

Disadvantages of Tables

- They do not give detailed information.
- May be time-consuming.

Line Graph

Line graphs or charts are a type of graph that displays information as a series of points, usually connected by a straight line. Some of the types of line graphs are highlighted below.

- Simple Line Graphs

Simple line graphs show the trend of data over time, and may also be used to compare categories. Let us assume we got the sales data of a firm for each quarter and are to visualize it using a line graph to estimate sales for the next year.

- LineGraphswithMarkers

These are similar to line graphs but have visible markers illustrating the data points

- StackedLineGraphs

Stacked line graphs are line graphs where the points do not overlap, and the graphs are therefore placed on top of each other. Consider that we got the quarterly sales data for each product sold by the company and are to visualize it to predict company sales for the next year.

Advantages of a Line Graph

- Great for visualizing trends and changes over time.
- It is simple to construct and read.

Disadvantage of a Line Graph

- It cannot compare different variables at a single place or time.

What are the Steps in Interpreting Data?

After data collection, you'd want to know the result of your findings. Ultimately, the findings of your data will be largely dependent on the questions you've asked in your survey or your initial study questions. Here are the four steps for accurately interpreting data

1. Gather the data

The very first step in interpreting data is having all the relevant data assembled. You can do this by visualizing it first either in a bar, graph, or pie chart. The purpose of this step is to accurately analyze the data without any bias.

Now is the time to remember the details of how you conducted the research. Were there any flaws or changes that occurred when gathering this data? Did you keep any observational notes and indicators?

Once you have your completed data, you can move to the next stage

2. Develop your findings

This is the summary of your observations. Here, you observe this data thoroughly to find trends, patterns, or behavior. If you are researching about a group of people through a sample population, this is where you analyze behavioral patterns. The purpose of this step is to compare these deductions before drawing any conclusions. You can compare these deductions with each other, similar data sets in the past, or general deductions in your industry.

3. DeriveConclusions

Once you've developed your findings from your data sets, you can then draw conclusions based on trends you've discovered. Your conclusions should answer the questions that led you to your research. If they do not answer these questions ask why? It may lead to further research or subsequent questions.

4. Give recommendations

For every research conclusion, there has to be a recommendation. This is the final step in data interpretation because recommendations are a summary of your findings and conclusions. For recommendations, it can only go in one of two ways. You can either recommend a line of action or recommend that further research be conducted.

How to Collect Data with Surveys or Questionnaires

As a business owner who wants to regularly track the number of sales made in your business, you need to know how to collect data. Follow these 4 easy steps to collect real-time sales data for your business using Formplus.

Step 1- Register on Formplus

- Visit Formplus on your PC or mobile device.
- Click on the Start for Free button to start collecting data for your business.
- Register with your email address or with Google in 2 seconds

Step 2- Start Creating Surveys For Free

- Go to the Forms tab beside your Dashboard in the Formplus menu.
- Click on Create Form to start creating your survey
- Take advantage of the dynamic form fields to add questions to your survey.
- You can also add payment options that allow you to receive payments using PayPal, Flutterwave, and Stripe.

Step 3- Customize Your Survey and Start Collecting Data

- Go to the Customize tab to beautify your survey by adding colors, background images, fonts, or even a custom CSS.
- You can also add your brand logo, color and other things to define your brand identity.
- Preview your form, share, and start collecting data.

Step4-TrackResponsesReal-time

- Trackyoursalesdatainreal-timeintheAnalyticssection.

WhyUseFormplustoCollectData?

- Analytics

The responses to each form can be accessed through the analytics section, which automatically analyzes the responses collected through Formplusforms.Thissectionvisualizesthecollecteddatausingtablesand graphs,allowinganalyststoeasilyarriveatanactionableinsightwithout goingthroughtherigorousprocessofanalyzingthedata.

- 30+FormFields

There is no restriction on the kind of data that can be collected by researchersthroughtheavailableformfields.Researcherscancollectboth quantitative and qualitative data types simultaneously through a single questionnaire.

- DataStorage

ThedatacollectedthroughFormplusaresafelystoredandsecuredinthe Formplusdatabase.Youcanalsochoosetostorethisdatainanexternal storage device.

- Real-timeaccess

Form plusgivesreal-time accessto information,making sure researchersare always informed of the current trends and changes in data. That way, researchers can easily measure a shift in market trends that inform important decisions.

- WordPressIntegration

Users can now embed Form plus forms into their Word Press posts and pagesusingashortcode.ThiscanbedonebyinstallingtheFormplusplug- inintoyourWordPresswebsites.

AdvantagesandImportanceofDataInterpretation

- Datainterpretationisimportantbecauseithelpsmakedata-driven decisions.
- Itsavescostsbyprovidingcostingopportunities
- Theinsightsandfindingsgottenfrominterpretationcanbeused tospot trendsinasectororindustry.

Conclusion

Data interpretation and analysis is an important aspect of working with data sets in any field or research and statistics. They both go hand in hand, as the process of data interpretation involves the analysis of data.

The process of data interpretation is usually cumbersome, and should naturally become more difficult with the best amount of data that is being churned out daily. However, with the accessibility of data analysis tools and machine learning techniques, analysts are gradually finding it easier to interpret data.

Data interpretation is very important, as it helps to acquire useful information from a pool of irrelevant ones while making informed decisions. It is found useful for individuals, businesses, and researchers.

1.7 WRITING

Official Letter

The best way to express an opinion or provide important information to others can be through an official letter. This is a professional way to explain you while using simple and concise sentences to avoid taking up the reader's time. Official letters follow a specific structure or format that must be maintained throughout the entire document.

In this article, we explain what an official letter is, how to write an official letter, and we provide a template and example of an official letter.

What is an official letter?

An official letter, also known as a "formal letter," is a document professionally written for another company or business professional. They can be used when applying for jobs, issuing a complaint, expressing interest in a job position, or thanking someone. Official letters are often written using simple and direct sentences with a formal greeting and signature included. Writing an official letter typically requires following a very structured and specific format.

Parts of a formal letter

An official letter is written in a formal tone. The most common (and preferred) layout used in modern business correspondence is known as the 'block format', in which all the parts of the letter are aligned to the left margin, one below the other. There are certain elements found in all official letters. These are listed below.

How to write an official letter

Creating a concise and clear official letter can help explain your intent and purpose in a way your audience may easily understand. Follow the steps below to

learn how to write an official letter.

1. Set up your font and margins.
2. Create your heading.
3. Write your salutation.
Use your body paragraph to state your reasons for writing.
4. Add your closing body paragraph and signature.
5. Mention and add your enclosures.
6. Proofread and send your letter.

1. Setup your font and margins

Before you begin, you want to ensure your letter is not only simple to understand, but simple to read as well. To keep your letter clean and professional, you should set your margins to be one inch per each side of the document. Using simple fonts like Verdana, Arial, Calibri or Times New Roman with a 12-point size will give you an official letter a clean look as well.

2. Create your heading

Once your fonts are set, you can begin addressing your letter. First, write your name in the top left-hand corner of the page. Include your name, address and the current date. You can also include your phone number and email if you are requesting further contact.

You can now input the recipient's address information directly beneath yours. Write their name, title of their organization if they are representing one, followed by the address. Review the name and address of your recipient more than once to ensure you've written the correct address and spelled their name right.

3. Write your salutation

You can now professionally greet your reader. A common salutation used in official letters is, "Dear Ms. or Mr. Lastname". If you know both their first name or last name, you can include that in the salutation. For example, you can write, "Dear Alex Smith". If you know their gender, you can write, "Dear Mr. Alex Smith" or "Dear Ms. Alex Smith". If you're unaware of the name of the recipient, you can write, "Dear Sir or Madam".

4. Use your body paragraphs to state your reasons for writing

The body paragraphs are where you can capture your main points and professionally explain your concerns, opinions or other information to your recipient. You can briefly introduce yourself and begin by explaining your reason for writing this letter. You can use verbiage such as, "I am writing to you today because..."

Once you've explained what the recipient will read, you can expand further throughout the next paragraph. Include details that support your first statement. For example, if you were writing a recommendation letter, you could expand on the skills of the person you're recommending by saying, "Avery's time-management and organizational skills have improved the efficiency of my business by 12% since the beginning of the quarter."

You can continue giving examples until you believe your point has been clearly understood by the reader. Keep your sentences short, simple and easy for the reader to understand.

Related: Asking for a Letter of Recommendation

5. Add your closing body paragraph and signature

To finalize your letter, you can write your conclusion paragraph. This paragraph can be short and will finalize the document by repeating your main point, explaining any possible next steps or thanking the recipient for taking the time to read your letter.

After closing the letter, you can provide your closing signature at the end of the document. Examples of common letter signatures are:

- Sincerely
- Sincerely yours
- With appreciation
- Thank you
- Regards
- Your truly
- Respectfully yours

Select your closing signature and write your name at the bottom of the letter.

6. Mention and add your enclosures

Enclosures are additional materials added to your letter to support your document, similar to when you attach a file to an email. If you're reattaching a document to complement your letter, you should mention it near the end of your letter. To inform the reader that an additional document is attached, you can include the word "enclosure" at the end of the letter after your name. You can also shorten the word by writing, "encl."

7. Proofread and send your letter

After you've finished writing, you can read through the letter to catch any grammatical or spelling errors. You can also review it to ensure it makes sense and is clear enough for the recipient to understand. Once proofread, you can send the letter to the recipient. Pick a plain white, square or rectangular envelope. Fold the letter properly so it fits in the envelope.

Write your name and address in the top left-hand corner of the envelope followed by the recipient's name and address in the middle. Put a stamp on the right-hand corner and send your letter to the desired recipient.

Official letters vs. unofficial letter

Since both official and unofficial letters are written documents used to send messages to others, it may be easy to confuse the two.

Official letters are often:

- Typed and never handwritten
- Following strict, standard grammar and English rules
- Containing short and concise sentences
- Using a specific, professional structure

Unofficial letters don't follow a structure as strict as official letters. Instead, official letters contain:

- Less professional and more casual language
- Words that are handwritten or typed
- No specific type of formatting or structure they have to follow

Official letter types

People may write official letters for various reasons that involve professionally expressing their interests, concerns or disagreements. Common official letter types can include:

Resignation letters

When an employee leaves their current position, they may send a brief resignation letter to their employer or hiring manager to explain their reason for leaving and to develop a plan for their transition process.

Cover letters

Writing a cover letter is one of the most common uses for official letters. Applicants can write cover letters when applying for a new job position, grant programs or educational programs.

Complaint letters

Many individuals or companies may use an official letter structure to express a complaint with a product or service. An employee may be asked to write a complaint letter on behalf of a company who is dissatisfied with a product used by its employees.

Professional thank you notes

After a job interview, an applicant may write a professional thank you note to express their gratitude to the employer for meeting with them and considering them for the position.

Letter of interest

If a candidate is interested in working for a company but doesn't see any job postings for their desired position, they may write a letter of interest stating that they would like to pursue a position with the company if an opportunity is available.

Letter of recommendation

When an applicant is applying for a job position or an educational program, the institution may ask for a letter of recommendation. The person writing the letter is often someone who worked closely with the applicant and is vouching for their qualifications for the position.

Business announcement

Companies who are expecting a significant change will write a business announcement that is released to the public. This can be an announcement for a new product, the filling of a leadership role or explaining an upcoming event they're hosting or attending.

What to include in an official letter

Official letters are often written using a professional tone and must include specific elements to remain professional and clear throughout the entire letter. To maintain proper official letter etiquette, you should include the elements below:

- A heading that lists your address and the recipient's address
- A formal salutation
- One paragraph stating your reasons for writing the letter
- Another paragraph expanding further on the introduction paragraph
- A final paragraph concluding the letter
- Closing letter signature
- Necessary enclosures to support the document

What not to include in an official letter

As you create your official letter for the desired audience, a professional voice and tone must be consistent throughout the entire document. To do this, you should avoid the following elements when writing an official letter:

- The phrase "Miss" in your salutation

- Being too formal that your letter sounds unclear, impersonal and difficult to understand
- Contractions
- Incomplete sentences
- Colorful font or stationery
- Lengthy sentences or paragraphs

Official letter template

The template below will show how to properly write an official letter. [Your name]

[Your street name and number]
[City, state zip code]

[Company name]
[Company street name and number]
[City, state zip code]

[Current date]

[Recipient name]
[Recipient job title]

Dear [recipient name],

[The first sentence of your first paragraph is an introduction and explains your reasoning for writing to the recipient. You can use the next two to three sentences to further explain the topic of your letter. Try to refrain from giving details or examples until the second paragraph.]

[This second paragraph will describe your point further. You can use examples or other details to inform the reader of your opinion or important information. The second paragraph should remain around three to four sentences long, meaning your letter should be short, concise and straightforward.]



Official letter example

Below is an example of an official letter. You can use this as a reference as you write your own official letter.

You write your own official letter.

Avery May 123 Kansas Ln Kansas City, MO 64105

Roberts Media Group 334
Sunflower Ln Kansas City, MO 64105

December 17, 2020

Cameron Jones Account Manager

Dear Ms. Cameron Jones,

I am writing to inform you of my resignation from Roberts Media Group as the Account Coordinator, effective two weeks from the current date.

I appreciate all the support, encouragement and motivation I've received during my time in this position. I have decided to pursue an opportunity where I can apply more of my team building and leadership skills. Over the next two weeks, I will continue to dedicate my time toward finishing the rest of my projects and will provide any necessary training to ease the transition process.

Thank you again for the support you've given me and thank you for taking the time to read this. If you would like to schedule a meeting to discuss this further, I would be happy to talk when you are free.

Sincerely,
Avery May
Enclosed:

List of my current projects scheduled to complete them all

RESUMEWRITING

RESUMEWRITING

1. A resume, sometimes called a CV or curriculum vitae, is “a document that lists your work experience, education, skills and achievements”. You’ll need a resume for almost any job application.
2. It’s considered essential information to give to an employer so they can weigh up whether you’re suitable for a role, and if they want to invite you to a job interview.

What should my resume include?

Personal details

Start by listing your full name and contact information, including your phone number and email address.

Career objective or summary

These are short statements to help you pitch yourself. If you’ve recently left school or university and don’t have much professional experience yet, begin your resume with a career objective – a sentence or two outlining your skills and your work ambitions. If you have experience in the workforce, you might want to include a short career summary instead, describing your experience and where you’re aiming to go next in your career. Next, include your education or work experience – start with whichever is more recent.

Education

List your latest education experience first and work backwards, this includes courses or qualifications you’ve completed at university, TAFE or other institutions that relate to the role you’re interested in applying for. Include your high schooling if it was less than five years ago. For each experience, include the qualification you received, where you studied, when you started and finished any special areas of study, plus awards or other achievements.

Work experience

List your most recent jobs including the title of your position, the name and location of the company or organization, and the dates you worked there. Place them in order with the most recent job first. Under each job, use bullet points to give a brief overview of your responsibilities and achievements, weaving in the skills you used. You can also mention relevant internships and volunteer work in this section – just make sure you identify that you volunteered or interned.

After this, it’s a good idea to add some more information to reinforce or add to the picture of what you’ve got to offer.

Skills, strengths or interests

You could create headings for these topics and list information that’s relevant to the job you’re applying for. Highlight any relevant professional memberships, too.

References

Most employers will require references from people you know professionally who can vouch for your skills and abilities. You could include contact and company details for a former employer, manager, or an academic advisor if they agree to be your referee, or you might wish to write "references available on request".

How long should my resume be?

Keep your resume short and to the point, so you can make a good impression when an employer takes a quick glance at it. Consider making your resume one or two pages if you have less than 10 years of professional experience. Senior executives or academics may like to have resumes that are three or more pages long.

What should it look like?

It's important to make sure the design and layout of your resume is neat and makes it easy to read. Use one or two clear fonts and use headings, bullet points and paragraphs to split up the text. While you're at it, make sure your spelling and grammar are correct.

What to leave out

Your resume is meant to give a summary of your skills and experience—so there's no need to include every detail. Some information isn't necessary in a resume:

Leave out personal details such as your home address, religion, age or marital status.

There's no need to list every job you've ever had—especially if a job isn't relevant to the role you're applying for now.

Don't include your salary expectations or previous salaries you've received—you can list this information in your SEEK Profile.

TYPES OF RESUME

1. Chronological Resume

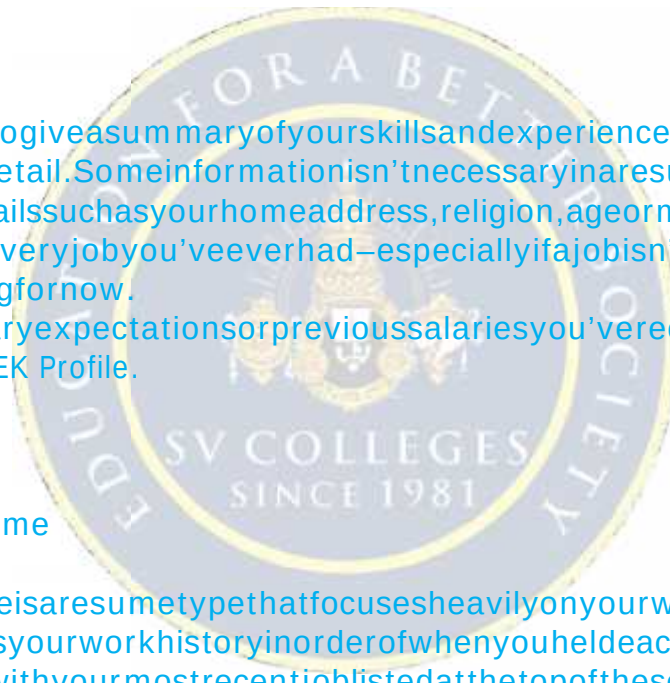
A chronological resume is a resume type that focuses heavily on your work history. Its key feature is that it lists your work history in order of when you held each position (in chronological order), with your most recent job listed at the top of the section.

The chronological format is the most common type of resume, and is considered the standard for most industries.

The two advantages of a chronological resume are:

It lets the hiring manager easily see how you've progressed in your career.

It puts your most relevant work experience at the top, where it'll be seen first by recruiters and employers.





2. Functional Resume

A functional resume is a type of resume designed to focus on your relevant professional skills rather than your chronological work history.

The defining feature of a functional resume is its expanded "Relevant Skills" section, which takes up the majority of your resume and replaces a detailed work experience section. Additionally, the "Relevant Skills" section of a functional resume groups your experience under skill categories instead of job titles. Under each category, bullet points are used to highlight examples of your accomplishments or other ways you've put your skills to work.

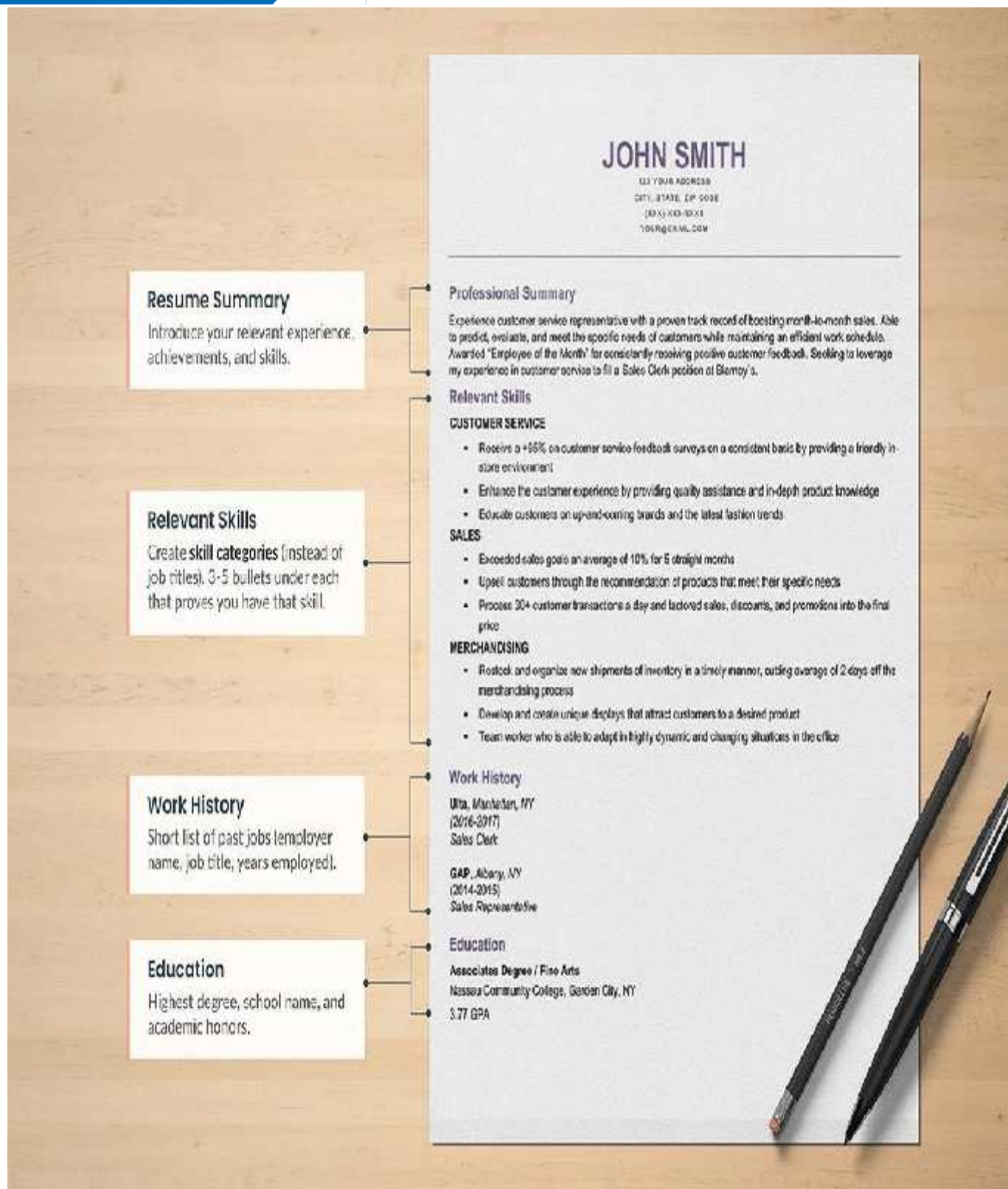
Who Should Use It

A functional resume will likely suit you if you're:

Changing industries

Someone with sizeable gaps in your work history





3. Combination Resume

A combination resume mixes the most useful elements of the chronological and functional resume formats.

It focuses on your skills, as a functional resume does, but also provides sample space for you to detail your work history—usually in chronological order.

Who Should Use It

Compared with the other types of resume formats, a combination resume is a good choice if you have any of the following to showcase:

Technical skills you've developed over a long, specialized career
Transferable skills, with full details of your work history

JOHN SMITH
123 FOUR ADDRESS, CITY, STATE, ZIP CODE | (555) 555-XXXX | YOUR@EMAIL.COM

Resume Summary
Introduce your relevant experience, achievements, and skills.

Technical Skills
Organize your relevant hard skills (best for senior-level, managerial, or highly skilled job seekers).

Work History
2-3 relevant jobs highlighting your expertise (skills + accomplishments); 3-5 bullets per job.

Education
Highest degree, school name, and academic honors.

Resume Summary
A general bookkeeper with 8+ years of experience using both single-entry and double-entry systems for medium-sized businesses. Specialize in performing bookkeeping for multimillion-dollar companies. Possess expertise in numerous pieces of bookkeeping software. Identified and eliminated departmental inefficiencies to increase productivity by 15%.

Relevant Skills

Finance

- Corrected spreadsheet error saving A/P \$3,500.
- Performed financial calculations such as amounts due, interest charges, balances, discounts, equity, and principal for a multimillion-dollar company.
- Certified QuickBooks Accountant.

Organization

- Checked figures, postings, and documents for correct entry, mathematical accuracy, and proper codes.
- Performed general office duties such as filing, answering telephones, and handling routine correspondence.
- Maintained error-free financial books for over 7 years.

Work Experience

GENERAL BOOKKEEPER
Franklin & Rodgers Business Solutions, Scottsdale, AZ / September 2012 - Present

- Accessed computerized financial information to answer general questions as well as those related to specific accounts.
- Formulated, prepared, and issued bills, invoices, and account and financial statements with 10% increased efficiency to ensure timely deliverable.
- Trained 3 new administrative assistants and junior bookkeepers.

ADMINISTRATIVE ASSISTANT BOOKKEEPER
Petion Group, Tempe, AZ / June 2010 - August 2012

- Operated computers programmed with accounting software to record, store, and analyze information.
- Operated 10-key calculators, typewriters, and copy machines to perform calculations and produce documents.
- Matched order forms with invoices, and record the necessary information.

Education

B.S. ACCOUNTING Wilhem University, 2013 Phoenix, AZ	A.S. ACCOUNTING Wilhem University, 2008 Phoenix, AZ	CERTIFIED BOOKKEEPER American Institute of Professional Bookkeepers, 2006
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4. Targeted Resume

A targeted resume is a resume that's tailored to address the specific needs of each company you apply to. You can format it as either a functional, combination, or chronological resume—the key difference is that you specifically target each detail to the role you're applying for.

To write an effective targeted resume, read through the job posting and look for any notable skills, job duties, keywords, or requirements that apply to you. Then, adjust your resume to highlight your most relevant skills and experience.

Writing a targeted resume takes longer than other types of resumes, because you need to research each company and write your resume to meet each job description's requirements. However, it's also the most effective resume you can write because it makes you look perfect for a specific job.



1.9 GRAMMAR & VOCABULARY

DIRECT AND INDIRECT SPEECH

There are many occasions in which we need to describe an event or action that happened, and very often that includes repeating what someone said. Such occasions can include a social situation as well as in a work email or presentation. In order to describe what people said there are two different types of speech – direct speech and indirect speech (or reported speech). Read on to find out more about these forms and improve your English storytelling skills.

Direct Speech

When we want to describe what someone said, one option is to use direct speech. We use direct speech when we simply repeat what someone says, putting the phrase between speech marks:

- Paul came in and said, “I’m really hungry.”

It is very common to see direct speech used in books or in a newspaper article. For example:

- The local MP said, “We plan to make this city a safer place for everyone.”

As you can see, with direct speech it is common to use the verb ‘to say’ (‘said’ in the past). But you can also find other verbs used to indicate direct speech such as ‘ask’, ‘reply’, and ‘shout’.

For example:

- When Mrs. Diaz opened the door, I asked, “Have you seen Lee?”
- She replied, “No, I haven’t seen him since lunchtime.”
- The boss was angry and shouted, “Why isn’t he here? He hasn’t finished that report yet!”

Indirect Speech

When we want to report what someone said without speech marks and without necessarily using exactly the same words, we can use indirect speech (also called reported speech).

For example:

- Direct speech: “We’re quite cold in here.”
- Indirect speech: They say (that) they’re cold.

When we report what someone says in the present simple, as in the above sentence, we normally don’t change the tense, we simply change the subject. However, when we report things in the past, we usually change the tense by moving it one step back. For example, in the following sentence the present simple becomes the past simple in indirect speech:

- Direct speech: "I have a new car."
- Indirect speech: He said he had a new car.

All the other tenses follow a similar change in indirect speech. Here is an example for all the main tenses:

DIRECT SPEECH	INDIRECT SPEECH
<i>He said, "I live in the city center."</i> (present simple)	<i>He said he lived in the city center.</i>
<i>He said, "I'm going out."</i> (present continuous)	<i>He said he was going out.</i>
<i>He said, "I've finished."</i> (present perfect)	<i>He said he had finished.</i>
<i>He said, "I've been studying a lot."</i> (present perfect continuous)	<i>He said he had been studying a lot.</i>
<i>He said, "I arrived before you."</i> (past simple)	<i>He said he had arrived before you.</i>
<i>He said, "I had already left."</i> (past perfect)	<i>He said he had already left. (remains the same)</i>
<i>He said, "I'll be there at 2pm."</i> (future simple)	<i>He said he would be there at 2pm.</i>
<i>He said, "I'm going to call Alan."</i> (be going to)	<i>He said he was going to call Alan.</i>

The same rule of moving the tenses one step back also applies to modal verbs. For example:

DIRECT SPEECH	INDIRECT SPEECH
<i>She said, "I can swim."</i>	<i>She said she could swim.</i>
<i>She said, "I must go."</i>	<i>She said she had to go.</i>
<i>She said, "I may drive there."</i>	<i>She said she might drive there.</i>
<i>She said, "Shall we start?"</i>	<i>She asked if we should start.</i>
<i>She said, "I'll call you."</i>	<i>She said she would call me.</i>

As an alternative to using 'say' we can also use 'tell' ('told' in the past) in reported speech, but in this case you need to add the object pronoun.

For example:

- He told me he was going to call Alan.
- They told her they would arrive a little late.
- You told us you'd already finished the order.

Changing Time Expressions

Sometimes it's necessary to change the time expressions when you report speech, especially when you are speaking about the past and the time reference no longer applies.

For example:

- Direct speech: "I'm seeing my brother tomorrow."
- Indirect speech: She said she was seeing her brother the following day.

Here are some other examples:

- Direct speech: "I had a headache yesterday."
- Indirect speech: You said you'd had a headache the day before yesterday.
- Direct speech: "It's been raining since this afternoon."
- Indirect speech: He said it'd been raining since that afternoon.
- Direct speech: "I haven't seen them since last week."
- Indirect speech: She said she hadn't seen them since the previous week.

Reporting Questions

When you report a question you need to change the interrogative form into an affirmative sentence, putting the verb tense one step back, as with normal reported speech.

There are two types of questions that we can report – questions that have a yes/no response, and questions that begin with a question word like 'what', 'where', 'who' etc. When we report a yes/no question, we use 'if'.

For example:

- Direct speech: "Do they live here?"
- Indirect speech: You asked me if they lived here.

As you can see, in the reported version of the question, 'do' is eliminated because it is no longer a question, and the verb 'live' becomes 'lived'.

For questions starting with question words like 'what', 'where', 'when', 'who', etc., we report the question using the question word but change the interrogative form to the affirmative form.

For example:

- Direct speech: "Where do they live?"
- Indirect speech: You asked me where they lived.
- Direct speech: "When are you leaving?"
- Indirect speech: He asked us when we were leaving.
- Direct speech: "How will they get there?"
- Indirect speech: She asked me how they would get there.

When we report a question we normally use the verb 'ask'. As with the verb 'to tell', the verb 'to ask' is normally followed by an object pronoun, though it is possible to omit it.

Reporting Orders and Requests

When you give someone an order, you use the imperative form, which means using just the verb without a subject.

For example:

- "Call me back later."
- "Have a seat."
- "Don't do that!"

To report an order we use 'tell' and the infinitive of the verb. For example:

- You told me to call you back later.
- He told me to have a seat.
- She asked us not to do that.

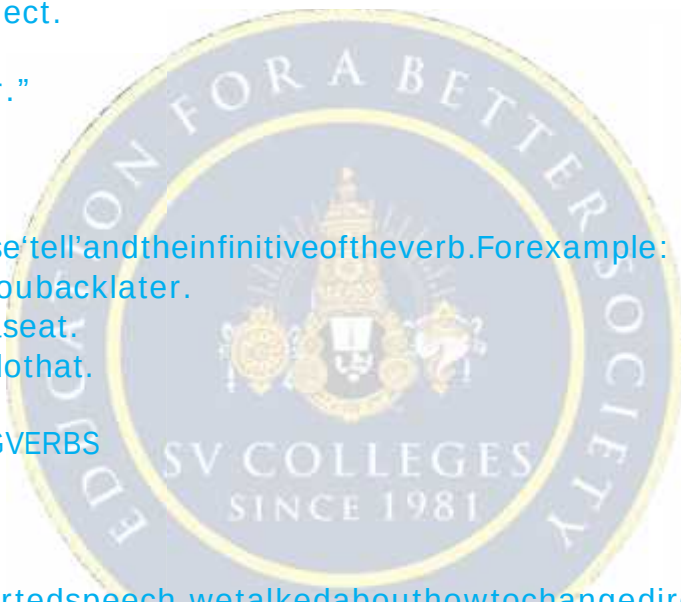
ACADEMIC REPORTING VERBS

Reporting Verbs

In the page about reported speech, we talked about how to change direct speech ("I love coffee") into reported speech (Sonja said that she loved coffee), using the verbs 'say', 'tell' and 'ask'. However, we can also use many other verbs to report what someone said, like 'promise', 'warn', 'advise' and 'recommend'.

Some of these verbs look a bit more complicated to use than 'say' and 'tell', but it's just a question of getting to know the verb patterns (or verb structures).

(As I'm sure you know, we can often choose if we want to use 'that' or not in English. I've put it in brackets () to show that it's optional. The meaning is exactly the same if you use 'that' or if you don't use 'that'.)



1: SAY

Let's look first at the verbs we've already talked about. The basic verb pattern for using 'say' for reported speech is:

say + (that) + clause

- She said (that) she had already eaten. (The direct speech for this is "I've already eaten".)

2: TELL

On the other hand, with 'tell' we need to use an object, a person whom we tell the information to.

tell + someone + (that) + clause

- I told John (that) he had seen the new film. (The direct speech for this is "I've seen the new film".)

When we are reporting orders, we can also use another pattern with 'tell':

tell + someone + to + infinitive

She told the children to go to bed.

3: ASK

We use 'ask' to report questions or requests. For questions we use the pattern:

ask + someone + if / question word + clause

- I asked my boss if I could leave early.
- She asked them where the station was.

(Remember, my first two examples with 'ask' are no longer real questions, so we use the normal sentence word order. We don't use inversion. We say 'she asked them where the station was', NOT 'she asked them where was the station'.)

Other reporting verbs follow a variety of patterns. I'm afraid there aren't any rules about which verbs follow which patterns. You need to learn each one.

4: ADVISE

(Give someone advice. Notice the different spelling for the verb and thenoun.)

Advise + someone + to + infinitive

She advised him to see a doctor.

Advise + (that) + clause

The staff advise that you carry water at all times.

Advise + against + verb-ing

I'd advise against leaving early.

5: AGREE



Agree + to + infinitive

We agreed to meet the following day.

Agree + (that) + clause

I agreed that the children could do their homework later.

6: APOLOGISE

Apologise + (to + someone) + for + verb-ing

- They apologized to us for being late.
- She apologized for forgetting the book.

Apologise (+ to + someone) + for + noun

- She apologized for the delay.

7: DECIDE

Decide + to + infinitive

- They decided to go to the cinema.

Decide + (that) + clause

- They decided that they would go to the cinema.

8: ENCOURAGE

Encourage + someone + to + infinitive

- She encouraged him to take the exam again.
- The teacher encouraged the students to ask questions.

9: EXPLAIN

Explain + (that) + clause

The teacher explained that the course was finished.

Explain + noun + to + someone

She explained the grammar to the students. (NOT: She explained me the grammar.)

Explain + question word + to + infinitive

- They explained how to buy a train ticket on the internet.
- John explained where to find the restaurant.



Explain + question word + clause

- We explained what the exams would cover.

10: INSIST

Insist + on + verb-ing

- He insisted on paying.

Insist + (that) + clause

- He insisted that we sit down.

11: PROMISE

Promise + to + infinitive

He promised to arrive early.

Promise + (someone) + (that) + clause

I promised him that I wouldn't do it again.

12: RECOMMEND

Recommend + verb-ing

I recommend visiting the British Museum while you're in London.

Recommend + (that) + clause

I recommend that you visit the British Museum

13: REMIND

Remind + someone + to + infinitive

She reminded him to take his keys.

Remind + someone + (that) + clause

They reminded me that there is a party tonight.

14: SUGGEST

Suggest + verb-ing

I suggest leaving soon

Suggest + (that) + clause

I suggest that you come as soon as you can. (NOT: I suggest you to come.)



15: WARN

Warn + someone + to + infinitive

I warned them not to go in the water.

Warn + someone + about + something

She warned us about the dangerous roads.

Negatives

To make the verb that we have reported negative, we need to look at the verb pattern:

- When there's a clause, we make the negative in the usual way: She said that she didn't like ice cream.
- When there's 'to + infinitive', we generally put 'not' before 'to': He promised not to do it again.
- When there's 'verb-ing', we generally put 'not' in front of it: I advised not taking the bus.

Advanced Point

In informal English, some verbs that are followed by '(that) + clause' use the infinitive instead of a present tense verb. Some people suggest that this is a kind of subjunctive in English. You only need to worry about this in very formal writing.

Mostly, this doesn't make a difference, because the present simple form in English is often the same as the infinitive form. But when the subject is 'he', 'she' or 'it' or when the verb is 'be', we can see it clearly.

- I advise that he go to bed early. (Normally we'd expect: I advise that he goes to bed early.)
- I insist that she come now. (Normally we'd expect: I insist that she comes now.)
- They suggested that the cats be put in the garden for the night. (Normally we'd expect: They suggested that the cats are put in the garden for the night.)

Active & Passive Voice

Introduction:

Active voice means that a sentence has a subject that acts upon its verb.

Passive voice means that a subject is a recipient of a verb's action.

Difference between Active & Passive Voice:

Active voice: When the subject of a sentence performs the verb's action, we say that the sentence is in the active voice. Sentences in the active voice have a strong, direct, and clear tone.

Ex: Monkey ate bananas. (Subject + Verb + Object)

The cashier counted the money. (Subject + Verb + Object)

The dog chased the squirrel.

(Subject + Verb + Object)

Passive Voice: In the passive voice, the subject is acted on by the verb. The passive voice is always constructed with a conjugated form of to be plus the verb's past participle.
 Ex: Bananas are eaten by monkeys.
 The money was counted by the cashier.
 The squirrel was chased by the dog.

When to use active and passive voice?

Active voice conveys a strong, clear tone & Passive voice is subtler and weaker.
 A good rule of thumb is to try to put the majority of your sentences in the active voice.
 Ex: An error has occurred with your account, but every attempt was made to remedy it. We have made an error with your account, but we made every attempt to remedy it.

Voice intensifies:

Simple present tense

Active: I write a novel.

Passive: A novel is written by me.

Structure: Subject + auxiliary verb + past participle of the main verb + by + object.

Present Continuous

Active: I am eating breakfast.

Passive: breakfast is being eaten by me.

Structure: Subject + auxiliary verb + being + by + object

Present Perfect

Active: I have played the game.

Passive: the game has been played by me.

Structure: Subject + has/have been + past participle + by + object

Past Tense

Active: I invited you to the party.

Passive: You were invited by me to the party.

Structure: Subject + be + past participle + by + object

Ex:

Active: Did you show me the dress?

Passive: Was I shown the dress by you? (IO)

Was the dress shown to me by you? (DO)

Past Continuous

Active: I was playing video games.

Passive: The video games were being played by me.

Structure: Subject + auxiliary verb + being + past participle + by + object

Past Perfect

Active: You had done the work.

Passive: The work had been done by you.

Structure: Subject + had + been + past participle + by + object

Future Tense

Active: He will play the match.

Passive: The match will be played by him

Structure: Subject + will + be + past participle + by + object

Future Perfect tense

Active: He will have played the match.

Passive: The match will have been played by him

Examples:

Active Voice	Passive Voice
Did you understand the lesson?	Was the lesson understood by you?
Do they sell building material?	Is building material sold by them?
Is she knitting a sweater?	Is a sweater being knit by her?
Will Neha buy the two-wheeler?	Will the two-wheeler be bought by Neha?
Should we offer money for the food?	Should money be offered for the food?
Has Rita read the books?	Have the books been read by Rita?
When did the management shut down the factory?	When was the factory shutdown by the management?
Give him some money	Let him be given some money
Make the bed	Let the bed be made
She writes stories	Stories are written by her
She is writing stories	Stories are being written by her.
She has written stories	Stories have been written by her.
She wrote stories	Stories were written by her
She was writing stories	Stories were being written by her.
She had written stories	Stories had been written by her.
She will write stories	Stories will be written by her
She will have written stories	Stories will have been written by her
The news editor briefed the young reporter	The young reporter was briefed by the news editor.
Suresh drinks coffee at breakfast	Coffee is drunk at breakfast by Suresh

Textual Exercises: Page (151)

Rewrite the following sentences using the words in brackets. Use the 'by + ...' phrase only if you think it is necessary:

We are shortlisting candidates for the interview. (being)

Candidates for the interview are being shortlisted.

1. The chairman praised Sarala for her good work. (was)
Sarala was praised by the chairman for her good work
2. People say that she is an excellent pilot. (said)
It is said that she is an excellent pilot.
3. The child will always remember the story. (Remembered)
The story will be remembered always by the child.
4. Find the lost documents immediately. (Found)
Let the lost documents be found immediately.
5. When are you buying the motorcycle? (Being)
When is the motorcycle being bought by you?
6. Can you pay the tuition fee tomorrow? (Paid)
Can the tuition fees be paid tomorrow by you?

Jargon

Jargon refers to terminology that is specific to an industry, trade, academic discipline, profession, or group. Words or phrases that require specialised knowledge to be understood fall under the category of jargon. Fields that use jargon include the military, music, economics, law, computing, and soon.

An example of jargon is the term *mens rea*, which is commonly used in law. It refers to the criminal intent of a person committing a crime. Hardly anyone outside the legal profession would use such a term, or even know what it means. Military jargon uses acronyms such as AWOL (that is, absent without official leave); police jargon uses codes such as 10-4 (meaning 'okay' or 'understood'); and an example of photography jargon is noise (referring to visual distortion in a digital photograph).

What differentiates jargon from the rest of a particular language is a specialised vocabulary. Jargon from a specific field can be understood without difficulty only by people who belong to that field. One advantage of jargon is that an in-group can communicate quickly and more efficiently using these specialised terms known to its members. However, it can be difficult to understand for anybody outside the group.

Unless absolutely necessary, do not use specialised technical terminology, unnecessarily complex words, or abbreviations that your reader might not understand. Adjust your style depending on the audience you are writing for. Make your writing style simpler and more accessible when it is meant to be read by non-specialist readers.

Before beginning to write, think about your audience. Who is the intended reader? How much does she/he already know about the topic? Will she/he understand what you are saying if you use jargon or technical terminology? Always write in such a way as to match the knowledge and language level of the intended reader.

If you do choose to use jargon or specialised vocabulary, be sure that you fully understand how those words are used. If you do not know the meaning of a word, look it up in a dictionary; if you do not understand it, do not use it. It is always better to use correct vocabulary than vocabulary that look impressive but is actually wrong.

8. Practice Quiz

Tick the right answer from the following options.

1. Saki is the pen name of _____? []
a) H. M. Munro b) O. Henry c) Alfred Tennyson d) None
2. Saki was born in the year _____ []
a) 1870 b) 1970 c) 1871 d) 1872
3. Squadron is _____? []
a) A unit of armed forces b) a unit of police c) a unit of country d) None
4. "The Toys of Peace" humorously narrates a failed attempt at _____ []
a) Reforming children's playthings b) politics c) wash-houses d) soldiers
5. Skirmish is a _____ []
a) a secret plan b) a short battle c) a bakery d) None
6. Battle of Waterloo held in the year _____ []
a) 1815 b) 1851 c) 1855 d) 1856
7. Darwin _____ a revolutionary new theory in 1859 []
a) revealed b) proposed c) concluded d) suggested
8. There has been a huge _____ in petrol prices []
a) rise b) raise c) rice d) race
9. The wrong use of words known as _____ []
a) Malapropism b) Kindness c) hedonism d) individualism
10. A single unit in a pie chart called as _____ []
a) a sector b) donut chart c) a circle d) a bargraph

9. Assignment

S.No	Question	BL	CO
1	Prepare your own resume	1	4
2	Prepare a conversational dialogue between student and librarian in informal context	1	4
3	What are some expressions for asking and giving information	1	4
4	Write a letter to request principal of your college for permission to go for industrial visit	1	4

10. SUPPORTIVE ONLINE CERTIFICATION COURSES
NPTEL

11. REALTIME APPLICATIONS

S. No	Application	CO
1	Exposure to language in formal & informal situations	1
2	Mechanics of Writing	2

12. Contents Beyond the Syllabus

1. If conditions
2. Information Transfer

13. Prescribed Text Books & Reference Books

Text Book:

1. PATHFINDER: A Skills Approach - I Edition 2023, Orient Black Swan.

References:

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2. Chase, Becky Tarver. Pathways: Listening, Speaking and Critical Thinking, Henley ELT; 2nd Edition, 2018.
3. Raymond Murphy's English Grammarian Use, Fourth Edition (2012) E-book.
4. Hewing, Martin. Cambridge Academic English (B2). CUP, 2012.
5. Oxford Learners Dictionary, 12th Edition, 2011.
6. Norman Lewis Word Power Made Easy - The Complete Handbook for Building a Superior Vocabulary Royal Reprint edition 2011